



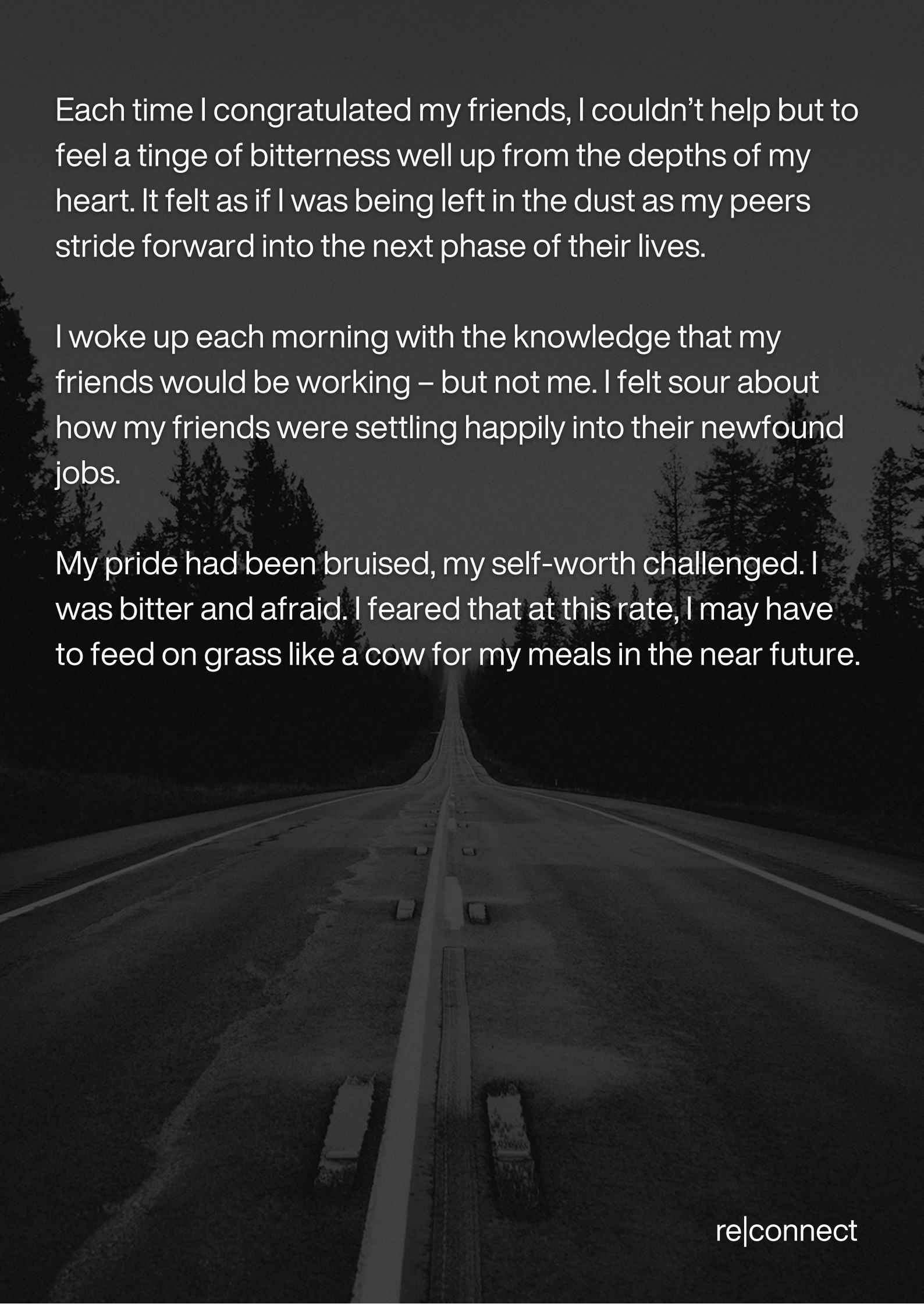
When I recently graduated from a local university, I had the same concern as most graduates: How can I secure a job that either pays well, or one that I'm passionate about?

I stepped out of university fresh and starry-eyed, ready to secure a respectable job and start earning a decent income.

I initially started with several carefully selected jobs. With each rejection, I would increase the pace and scope of my application process.

Within months, dejection and self-doubt had fuelled my morphosis into a resume-sending machine.

Amid the flurry of applications and the numerous rejections, it didn't help that I couldn't help but keep tabs on my peers' success in getting employment. The joy they felt at moving from an unwilling bum to a desirable contributing member of working society was shared on social media posts, during catch-ups, or – ironically – when they whined about a tough day at work.



Each time I congratulated my friends, I couldn't help but to feel a tinge of bitterness well up from the depths of my heart. It felt as if I was being left in the dust as my peers stride forward into the next phase of their lives.

I woke up each morning with the knowledge that my friends would be working – but not me. I felt sour about how my friends were settling happily into their newfound jobs.

My pride had been bruised, my self-worth challenged. I was bitter and afraid. I feared that at this rate, I may have to feed on grass like a cow for my meals in the near future.